

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 7

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 4 3

♥ J 7

♦ K J 4 3

♣ K Q J 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 6 5

♥ A K 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 8 5

♦ A 6

♣ A 10 6

[showcards W:S5 N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠5, dummy played the ♠2

Play the ♠7.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you he has an honor in the suit, so it must be either the ♠Q or the ♠10. North's jump to 2NT makes it almost certain that he holds the ♠Q, so you can figure partner probably led from ♠10 x x 5.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

North will take the ♠Q at trick 1, but when East wins a high ♥ he will play another ♠ through dummy's ♠K 9 to your ♠A J. Once you clear dummy's ♠ away partner will win another ♥ and be able to cash his last ♠.

Apply the Rule of 11. 11 minus 5 = 6 cards higher than the ♠5 held by dummy, you, and declarer.

Since you can see 5 of the 6 you conclude that that declarer will have to play his ♠Q to beat your ♠7.

Note that if dummy's ♠9 was played you would cover with your ♠J, leading to the same situation.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 2
 ♥ J 10 6 5 2
 ♦ 6 4
 ♣ 9 3

♠ J 6 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A 5

♣ A J 10 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 3

♥ A Q 7

♦ J 10 8 7 3

♣ K 6

♠ A Q 10

♥ K 4 3

♦ K Q 9 2

♣ Q 8 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to West.

So assume South actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, South will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? South could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like West probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

[showcards W:H5 N:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in North, East and South that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for South.

West cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that South must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter